

Codebook and Data Set Changes

Changes to the ID Variables

In order to establish comparability across waves and between the HRS and AHEAD studies, some of the identification variables in prior releases of the AHEAD data have been changed. The current release, and future data releases, will contain the following identification variables: HN, HHID, PN, HHIDPN, and nSUBHH (where 'n' uniquely identifies the year of collection).

Recoded Variables

For confidentiality reasons, V141 (HISPANIC TYPE, BRACKETED) has been recoded to a four-bracket range. The new codes and code value labels are 1=Mexican American /Chicano, 2=Puerto Rican, 3=Cuban American, and 4=Other.

HHID has been recoded to begin with 20. This was done in order to make the ID compatible with future waves of AHEAD.

Re-Named Variables

Variables in the Persons dataset have been renamed as follows:

V5000=HHMEMADD	V5016=V427	V6004=V445
V5001=V417 V5002=V418	V5017=V428	V6005=V446
V5003=V419	V5018=V429	V6006=V447
V5004=V421 V5005=V422	V5019=V487	V6006YR=V447YR
V5005YR=V422YR	V5019YR=V487YR	V6007=V449
V5006=V423 V5007=V424	V5020=V430	V6008=V450
V5008=V480	V5021=V431	V6009=V451
V5009=V481	V5022=V488	V6010=V452
V5009C=V481C	V5023=V489	V6011=V454
V5010=V482 V5014=V425	V5023C=V489C	V6012=V455
V5015=V426	V5024=V490	V6013C=V458C
	V6000=NRCHDADD	V6016=V459
	V6001=V442	V6016YR=V459YR
	V6002=V443	V6017=V460
	V6003=V444	V6018=V461

Variables in the Helpers data set have been renamed as follows:

V8001=V990	V8006=V996	V8011=V1000
V8002=V992	V8007=V997	V8012=V1001
V8003=V993	V8008=V998	V8013=OTHRHELP
V8004=V994	V8009=V996R	V8014=GRKIDREL
V8005=V995	V8010=V999	RELATEP=BRELATEP

Problems in the Dataset that were not changed

Many additional consistency checks have been done since the previous release, and corrections made where possible, including corrections to key ID and structural variables. However, there are some problems in the dataset that have not been corrected for this release. Some of these problems include:

1. Cases with reported job income larger than household income.
2. Cases with reported trust assets larger than total assets.
3. Households in which couples report different numbers of children or different dates on which their marriage began or they began living together.
4. Letter missing data codes other than .D and .R have been documented in this release. We hope to have changed them to other missing or non-missing codes in the next release.
5. Zero or other small code values that look problematic on certain financial variables.
6. INAP codes (dot) on dollar amount variables. For some of these, when the respondent does not have a particular asset or source of income, it would be advisable prior to some analyses to recode these INAP codes as non-missing zeros, so the INAP codes do not function as implicit filters and exclude these cases from the analysis.
7. There are five variables in the household level dataset with illegal or undocumented codes (V1777A1, V1793, V1795, DEBTF AND HHINCF). These variables will be corrected or explained in the next data release.

Variables Dropped from the Data set

Variables have been dropped from the data set for various reasons. Variables were dropped or recoded in order to maintain respondent confidentiality. Other variables dropped from the data set include: bracketed range variables (replaced with "C variables"; financial derived variables, if we had a better variable; and variables with 100% missing data.

Confidential Variables

RESPONDENTS DATASET

V129 A3c. R HIGHEST DEGREE

Derived Variables

The month ("R") and year ("Y") type of financial variables were dropped when we had a better version of the variable. E.g., If we had an imputed ("X") version then both of the associated month and year versions were dropped. If we had a year version and no imputed variable, the associated month version was dropped.

HOUSEHOLDS DATASET

V1047Y	F6a RETIREHM ANNUAL FEE
V1069Y	F11a PARK ASSOC ANNUAL FEE
V1123Y	F32 MORTGAGE ANNUAL PAYMENT
V1128Y	F33a 2ND MORTGAGE ANNUAL PAYMENT
V1133Y	F37a HOME LOAN ANNUAL PAYMENT
V1460R	J21 R REG INC 1-MONTHLY
V1460Y	J21 R REG INC 1-ANNUAL
V1478R	J21 R REG INC 2-MONTHLY
V1478Y	J21 R REG INC 2-ANNUAL
V1495R	J21 R REG INC 3-MONTHLY
V1495Y	J21 R REG INC 3-ANNUAL
V1520R	J31 SP REG INC 1-MONTHLY

V1520Y	J31 SP REG INC 1-ANNUAL
V1542R	J31 SP REG INC 2-MONTHLY
V1542Y	J21 SP REG INC 2-ANNUAL
V1563R	J31 SP REG INC 2-MONTHLY
V1563Y	J21 SP REG INC 3-ANNUAL
V1587Y	J42b FIN INVEST INC-ANNUAL-1
V1593Y	J42b FIN INVEST INC-ANNUAL-21

HOUSEHOLDS DATASET (continued)

V1599Y	J43d.INCOM INVEST-ANNUAL
V1773R	K18f. ADD TO SAVINGS, MONTHLY
V1887R	R12b. R TERM INS PAY MONTHLY
V1895R	R15b. R LIFE INS PAY MONTHLY
V1903R	R19b SP TERM INS PAY MONTHLY
V1912R	R22b SP LIFE INS PAY MONTHLY
V1414R	J7. SSI LAST MONTH
V1414Y	J7 SSI IN CALENDAR YR
V1432R	J13. FDSTP-LAST MONTH
V1432Y	J13 FOODSTAMP-CALENDAR YR
V1379Y	R/SP ANNUAL SS
V1390Y	SP ANNUAL SS

For Other Reasons:

RESPONDENTS DATASET

PCOG1	PROXY COGN RATE
PCOG2	PROXY COGN ACT
PCOG3	PROXY COGN IMPAIR
COGN	SELF&PROXY COGNITIVE IMPAIRMENT

HOUSEHOLDS DATASET

V1793F	IMP TYPE FLAG K37-1
V1742F	(No label)

Bracketed Range Variables

HOUSEHOLDS DATASET

V1619	J46a. \$500 DK1 >\$5K -2
V1620	J46b. \$500 DK2 >\$10K -2
V1621	J46c. \$500 DK3 >\$50K -2
V1622	J46d. \$500 DK4 >\$1K -2
V1682	J54a. OTH HH \$ DK >\$30K

OTHER PERSONS DATASET

V6013	D30. NRCHILD INCOME >\$30K
V6014	D31. NRCHILD INCOME >\$50K
V6015	D32. NRCHILD INCOME >\$20K
V5011	D11b. HHM DK >\$30K
V5012	D11c. HHM DK >\$50K
V5013	D11d. HHM DK >\$20K
V5025	D18b. HHM SP DK >\$30K
V5026	D18c. HHM SP DK >\$50K
V5027	D18d. HHM SP DK >\$20K
V527	D52. CHILD-4 \$ AMOUNT

Weights

These variables were dropped from the Respondent and Other Persons Dataset because they are only useful for household level analysis.

WTHHPOP	HOUSEHOLD ANALYSIS POPULATION WEIGHT
WTHHNORM	HOUSEHOLD ANALYSIS WEIGHT-CENTERED

Codebook Improvements

Variables formerly documented in the "Derived Variables" section have been moved into the sections that contain their original variable.

Original items that were out of place have been moved in place.

Variables in all four data sets have been re-ordered so they are now in the same order as the codebook.

Many variable labels have been clarified and expanded.